

PASSWITHPURPOSE

NEW
2027
FORMAT

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

Extended Response *Workbook*

Step-by-step practice for Paper 1 Question 4 (250–300 words, 20 marks): six original passages, one in each exam form, with a model answer for every one.

- ◆ 6 original passages
- ◆ Mine → Stretch → Voice
- ◆ Indicative content per bullet
- ◆ Retell → develop ladder
- ◆ All six Q4 forms
- ◆ Three-column planning pages
- ◆ 6 model answers (250–300 words)
- ◆ Marking bands & tracker

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For exams in 2027, 2028 and 2029. Independent practice material; not produced or endorsed by Cambridge University Press & Assessment. All passages are original.

The method

In Question 4 candidates write 250–300 words in a given form, usually in the voice of someone connected to Text C, responding to three bullet points. Reading and writing earn 10 marks each. The biggest trap is **retelling the text in order** with a greeting on top.

Mine	Treat each bullet as its own mini-question. Find every relevant detail in the text for it.
Stretch	Top answers go beyond the text: they develop ideas and make reasonable inferences rooted in it.
Voice	Write convincingly as the given person, in the given form, for the given audience.

From retelling to developing

Retelling	“The keeper saved four lives from a fishing boat.”
Using	“I once guided a fishing boat home and saved four men.”
Developing	“Four men went home to their families. That was the job.”
Inferring in voice	“Not the brass or the polish, but that: being awake when others needed someone to be.”

The six forms

Journal	Date or time; first person; private, reflective, honest
Report	Title; purpose; subheadings; objective tone; recommendations
Interview	Speaker labels; purposeful questions; developed answers
Speech	Address the audience; direct appeals; strong close
Letter	Greeting; clear purpose; register to suit the reader; sign-off
Article	Headline; engaging opening; lively paragraphs; final line

Passages 1–3 are guided (with a planning page). Passages 4–6 are independent. Model answers follow at the back.

AVOID THESE

Five mistakes that cost Q4 marks

Mistake	Weak	Strong
Retelling in order	A greeting, then the story from start to finish.	Reorganise the details around the three bullets.
Missing a bullet	Two bullets developed; the third squeezed into one sentence.	Plan three columns and give each bullet real space.
Wrong voice	A lighthouse keeper who sounds like a student writing an essay.	Short, understated sentences; echoes of his own words.
Contradicting the text	"The engineers were rude and kept me waiting."	Inferences must fit the text: "polite and young and in a hurry".
Copying	Lifting whole sentences from the passage.	Reshape details in the character's own words.

THE TEST: If you removed the greeting and sign-off, would your answer still be clearly a letter, speech or journal? The form should show in every paragraph, not just at the top.

The Last Watch

- 1 My father kept the lighthouse at Ras Hamra for twenty-six years, and on the night before it became automatic, he let me stay up with him for the last watch.
- 2 The lamp room was warm and smelled of brass polish and paraffin, although the great lamp had not burned paraffin for decades. My father still polished the lens every evening, turning the cloth in slow circles across the glass prisms, as if it might notice if he stopped. ‘Tomorrow a computer does this,’ he said. ‘It will never be late and it will never fall asleep. And it will never care.’
- 3 He showed me the logbook, its pages filled with his small, neat handwriting: weather, passing ships, the night a fishing boat lost its engine and he guided it in with the signal lamp, flashing instructions until three in the morning. He had never told me that story. He had saved four lives, and he had written it down in two lines, between a note about wind speed and a reminder to order more oil.
- 4 At midnight we stood on the gallery outside. The wind pulled at our jackets and the beam swept over the dark water, round and round, like a slow, patient heartbeat. Far out, the lights of a tanker slid past. ‘They’ll never know,’ my father said, ‘that it’s the last night anybody watches for them.’
- 5 At dawn, engineers arrived in a white van. They were polite and young and in a hurry. My father handed over the keys, shook their hands, and then walked down the spiral stairs without looking back.
- 6 Only later, in the car, did I notice that he had taken the logbook with him, tucked inside his coat like something alive.

Task [20 marks: 10 reading + 10 writing]: Imagine you are the lighthouse keeper. That evening, after leaving the lighthouse for the last time, you write a journal entry.

In your journal you should:

- describe your final night and morning at the lighthouse
- explain what the job has meant to you, including the night of the fishing boat
- reflect on your feelings about the lighthouse becoming automatic, and about your future.

Base your journal on what you have read, but be careful to use your own words. Address each bullet point.

Write about **250 to 300 words**.